

You said it...



tricks (though they are still at it). FOSS is now the race-horse chariot in the hands of the Ben Hurs of the world, as against the proprietary chariot of the Missalaha.

—J S Karkada, Bangalore, eddykaboortar@yahoo.com



I would have digested Vaibhav's comments easily because all are free to express their views, but the topic, 'We do not deserve the pride of being open', which my friend selected, forced me to write something politely in reply to his aggressive message. And my message is not for any individual; I want to clear this issue with everyone.

The culture of computing means technology and we, the open source users, are far ahead in this field. I have tweaked each and every release of Windows 95, right through to Windows 7 and tens of Linux distros. But there is something in the open world that I don't get in the 'closed' sector. How can we compare Linux to Windows by just considering a few random software? I don't understand why we should even go with GUIs.

A server never demands better GUI effects; all that matters is powerful networking and lawful data management. And if Linux is lagging behind here, then please write and let us know. That is why Linux/UNIX is the first choice of systems administrators.

When developers are busy improving virtualisation, why would they divert their efforts to make OpenOffice.org mimic MS Office 2007? The editors like Vim and Emacs are quite challenging to work with, but I love it and that is the real flavour of Linux. Just think of a technology where all are free to develop their programs.

I want to share an experience I had when I installed Fedora 12. My VGA, Ethernet, sound card, Bluetooth,

webcam, touch pad, card reader, face recognition, and Sify broadband (without adding any package) all worked out of the box. I'm even using Win XP, Win 7, Ubuntu Karmic-Kola, Debian and SUSE (through Xen) and all work fine. So is this an example of 'hard labour'? And then we state, 'It's us, the open source community, that is lagging behind.'

I want to draw your attention to the Grub bootloader, the Linux filesystem, Samba and the emulators. Grub facilitates installing Windows alongside Linux. We can access NTFS drives, files and executables, from within Linux. You might ask why can't an operating system that provides so many facilities offer a better GUI? Well, this is the only thing in Linux for which there has been no demand. Yet, Ubuntu and SUSE are continuously developing better GUIs than Windows—check the sharpness and clarity of their 3D desktops.

The day is not far when all the tech giants will contribute to the open world. Microsoft is doing its work and we are doing ours. There's a lot more to say, but I'd like to conclude with: Help FOSS in its work rather than criticise it, because FOSS is *by the users and for the users*.

—Adarsh Singh, addi_adarsh@yahoo.co.in

New mag for BSD



As you've done with Linux, I request you to launch a magazine for the BSD community in India. I personally use PC-BSD and Desktop BSD, besides Ubuntu, and I think it would be great to have a BSD magazine.

—Ashik [mailto:ashiktrissur@aol.com]

ED: While we appreciate your point, the economics of producing such a niche publication presents a major challenge. However, since LFY is a magazine on open source,



3rd

Largest UPS Company of India

climbing from the 10th to the 3rd position in just 5 years*

► Full Range of UPS Systems

► Wide Customer Base

► All India Sales & Service Network

D SERIES
High Power IGBT UPS Upto 1000 KVA

GIGALINE
IGBT UPS Upto 200 KVA

MAXILINE
IGBT UPS Upto 100 KVA

GREENLINE
Online UPS Upto 6 KVA

SMARTLINE
Offline UPS Upto 3 KVA

POWERLINE
CTV - SERVO Upto 1000 KVA

Uniline Energy Systems (Pvt) Ltd, Uniline House, Ramesh Market, East of Kailash, New Delhi - 110 065. Tel. : 011 - 4666 1111, 2646 9031, 2646 9108
Chandigarh : 92167 63793 Chennai : 99400 49677, 98841 42866, Dehradun : 98972 72449 Jaipur : 98290 60772 Kanpur : 94151 32093, 93368 55700 Kolkata : 94330 33855, 98833 59262
© ANILYSD 011 - 29953 4518 011 - 2012102 UNILIN